

FIVE WORLD CUP FLASHPOINTS **VAR** WOULD PUT ON TRIAL

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Geoff Hurst's 'ghost goal' — England vs West Germany, 1966 World Cup

England won its only World Cup title when the tournament came to British shores in 1966, defeating West Germany in the final at Wembley. However, the result might have been very different had goal-line technology existed.

After a 2-2 draw in regulation time, England pressed forward in the first half of extra-time. With four minutes to go, Alan Ball whipped in a cross from the right for Geoff Hurst to control. The forward spun past his centre-back and unleashed a shot towards goal that bounced off the crossbar towards the goal-line before spinning out.

Gottfried Dienst, the referee, and the linesman were initially unclear whether the ball had crossed the line, but after some discussion, awarded the goal.

West Germany, now forced to chase the game, conceded again as Hurst completed his hat-trick to secure England's only World Cup triumph and ensure that, for the first and only time, football "came home".

Maradona's 'Hand of God' — England vs Argentina, 1986 World Cup

Few performances justify Diego Maradona's 'mercurial' tag better than Argentina's quarterfinal against England in 1986, where he produced two of football's most infamous and incredible moments.

Early in the second half, with the score goalless, Maradona picked up the ball near the halfway line and drove infield towards the English penalty box before laying it off to Jorge Valdano. Valdano miscontrolled, and Steve Hodge attempted to hook the ball away towards his own goal.

Peter Shilton advanced to collect the aerial ball, but could only reach second after the raised fist of Maradona, who knocked the ball into the vacant net. Referee Ali Ben Nasser failed to spot the handball, thus creating the 'Hand of God'.

Later in the game, Maradona scored one of the great World Cup goals, dribbling through the entire English side before slotting home. But with television replay technology, there is no saying whether Argentina would have moved on to its second World Cup title.

